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Signal transmitting device

Abstract

A signal transmitting device is configured to transmit a radio frequency signal outputted from a chip. The signal transmitting device includes a substrate and a connector. The substrate is coupled to the chip. The substrate includes a waveguide, and the waveguide is configured to transmit the radio frequency signal along a first direction. The connector is coupled to the substrate and configured to extract the radio frequency signal from the substrate to transmit the same along a second direction. The second direction is perpendicular to the substrate.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims the benefit of priority to Patent Application No. 110138184, filed in Taiwan on Oct. 14, 2021, which is incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present application relates to a signal transmitting device, particularly to a radio frequency signal transmitting device.

BACKGROUND

(3) Insertion loss is one of the important parameters of the quality of radio frequency signal transmission. When there are different conductors on the transmission path, it is necessary to make proper impedance matching on the path to reduce the insertion loss. Especially when the frequency of the radio frequency signal increases, the insertion loss increases with the rise in frequency. Therefore, how to effectively reduce the insertion loss in radio frequency signal transmission has become an important issue in this field.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(4) An aspect of the present disclosure provides a signal transmitting device configured to transmit a radio frequency signal outputted from a chip. The signal transmitting device includes a substrate and a connector. The substrate is coupled to the chip. The substrate includes a waveguide. The

waveguide is configured to transmit the radio frequency signal along a first direction. The connector is coupled to the substrate, and configured to extract the radio frequency signal from the substrate and transmit the same along a second direction. The second direction is perpendicular to the substrate.

(5) Another aspect of the present disclosure provide a signal transmitting device configured to transmit a radio frequency signal outputted from a chip. The signal transmitting device includes a microstrip, a substrate, and a connector. The microstrip is coupled to the chip and configured to receive the radio frequency signal. The substrate is coupled to the microstrip and configured to transmit the radio frequency signal along a first direction in the transverse electric mode. The connector is configured to extract the radio frequency signal from the substrate along a second direction. The second direction is perpendicular to the first direction.

(6) The signal transmitting device of the present disclosure uses a substrate and through holes on the substrate to form a waveguide to transmit radio frequency signals and vertically conducts the radio frequency signals out of the substrate. Compared with the conventional technology, the signal transmitting device of the present disclosure has better impedance matching and better transmission efficiency.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Various aspects of the present application can best be understood upon reading the detailed description below and accompanying drawings. It should be noted that the various features in the drawings are not drawn to scale in accordance with standard practice in the art. In fact, the size of some features may be deliberately enlarged or reduced for the purpose of discussion.

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram illustrating a signal transmitting device according to some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram illustrating a conductive layer and a microstrip according to some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3, FIG. 4, and FIG. 5 are schematic cross-sectional views of a signal transmitting device according to some embodiments of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(5) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram illustrating a signal transmitting device **10** in the X-Z plane according to some embodiments. The signal transmitting device **10** is configured to transmit a radio frequency signal **S** outputted from a chip **20**. The signal transmitting device **10** includes a substrate **100**, a microstrip **200**, and a connector **300**. The substrate **100** is a bilayer structure having a conductive layer **110** and a conductive layer **120**, which are separated by a dielectric layer **130** with a distance **h**. The chip **20** is disposed on the substrate **100** and is configured to transmit the radio frequency signal **S** to the microstrip **200** via the pin **21** of the chip **20**. The microstrip **200** is coupled between the pin **21** and the conductive layer **110** and configured to transmit the radio frequency signal **S** to the conductive layer **110**. The connector **300** is disposed on the substrate **100** and configured to extract the radio frequency signal **S** from the substrate **100**.

(6) In some embodiments, the substrate **100** is a bilayer printed circuit board, and the microstrip **200** and the conductive layer **110** are monolithic conductive structures on one side of the bilayer printed circuit board. In other words, the monolithic conductive structure disposed above dielectric layer **130** in FIG. 1 is patterned to obtain the microstrip **200** and the conductive layer **110**. The conductive layer **120** is a ground layer formed by the monolithic conductive structure on the other side of the bilayer printed circuit board (i.e., below the dielectric layer **130**). In some embodiments, the dielectric layer **130** includes dielectric materials of Megtron series, e.g., Megtron 6. The chip **20**, the microstrip **200** and the conductive layer **110** are arranged at the same side of the substrate

100. The chip **20** is further connected to the ground by coupling to the conductive layer **120** by a via VP.

(7) In the transmission path of the radio frequency signal S, the radio frequency signal S is transmitted on the microstrip **200** and the substrate **100** along the X direction and transmitted on the connector **300** along the Z direction. Because of the different shapes and materials of the transmission medium and the different transmission directions, the design of the microstrip **200**, the substrate **100** and the connector **300** must respond to the frequency and mode of the radio frequency signal S to do impedance matching in order to maintain the transmission quality, as detailed below.

(8) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram illustrating the conductive layer **110** and the microstrip **200** of the substrate **100** in the X-Y plane. The microstrip **200** is trapezoidal in the X-Y plane, with a short side having a length of W1 and a long side having a length of W2, and adjoining the conductive layer **110**, wherein the distance between the long side and the short side is L1. In an embodiment, the radio frequency signal S is transmitted in the microstrip **200** in a transverse electromagnetic mode (TEM mode).

(9) In some embodiments, the distance L1 is approximately 0.5- to one-fold of the wavelength of the radio frequency signal S transmitted on the substrate **100**. For example, when the frequency of the radio frequency signal S is 60 GHz, the distance L1 can be 2 mm. In this embodiment, the length W1 is about 0.2 mm, and the length W2 is about 0.67 mm.

(10) The substrate **100** includes a plurality of through holes VG and a plurality of through holes VS, wherein the through holes VG and through holes VS have a diameter of D. As shown in FIG. 2, the plurality of the through holes VG are disposed in through hole rows R1 and R2 on the conductive layer **110** along the X direction, and the plurality of the through holes VS are arranged in the through hole column C1 on the conductive layer **110** along the Y direction. Each of the through hole rows R1 and R2 has a same number of through holes VG, and the centers of circle of two adjacent through holes VG in the through hole rows R1 and R2 are spaced by a pitch P. There is a distance A between the center of circle of one through hole VG in the through hole row R1 and the center of circle of a corresponding through hole VG in the through hole row R2. In other words, the distance between the through hole row R1 and the through hole row R2 is A. The shortest distance between the edge of a through hole VG in the through hole row R1 and the edge of a corresponding through hole VG in the through hole row R2 is Ag. The substrate **100** uses the region surrounded by the through hole rows R1, R2 and the through hole column C1 as a waveguide, which is configured to transmit the radio frequency signal S. In some embodiments, the substrate **100** is also referred to as a substrate integrated waveguide (SIW).

(11) In some embodiments, the radio frequency signal S is transmitted in the waveguide in the transverse electric mode (TE mode), such as transmitted in the TM.sub.1,0 mode. In this embodiment, a conduction frequency of the radio frequency signal S of 60 GHz in the TM.sub.1,0 mode is about 42.86 GHz. A relationship between the diameter D, the pitch P and the distance A can be obtained from following Equations (1) and (2).

$$(12) f_c = \frac{c}{2 \times \sqrt{\epsilon_r}} (A_{eq}^{-1}) \quad (1) \quad A_{eq} = A - \frac{D^2}{0.95 \times P} \quad (2)$$

wherein f.sub.c is a cutoff frequency of the radio frequency signal S, c is the speed of light, and $\epsilon_{sub.r}$ is the dielectric constant of the dielectric layer **130**.

(13) In some embodiments, the dielectric constant of the dielectric layer **130** is about 3.6, the diameter D is about 0.2 mm, the pitch P is about 0.3 mm, and the distance A is about 1.99 mm.

(14) In some embodiments, the distance Ag and the length W2 can be expressed as the following Equation (3).

$$W2 \approx 0.4 \times Ag \quad (3)$$

(15) Reference is made to both FIG. 3 and FIG. 4. FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view of the substrate **100** in the X-Z plane obtained by a cross-sectional line passing through the center of circle of each

through hole VG in the through hole column R1. FIG. 4 is a cross-sectional view of the substrate **100** in the X-Z plane obtained by a cross-sectional line passing through the center of circle of each through hole VS in the through hole row C1. The through holes VG and the through holes VS are hollow structures in the dielectric layer **130**. The plurality of the through holes VG and the through holes VS penetrate the dielectric layer **130** from the conductive layer **110** to the conductive layer **120** along the Z direction.

(16) Returning to FIG. 2, the conductive layer **110** includes a circular hollow pattern **111**. The circular hollow pattern **111** separates the conductive layer **110** into an inner region **110a** and an outer region **110b** that are mutually insulated, and the center of circle of the circular hollow pattern **111** and the through hole column C1 are separated by a distance L2. In some embodiments, a diameter D2 of the outer boundary of the circular hollow pattern **111** is about 0.7 mm, and a diameter D3 of the interior boundary forming the hollow pattern **111** is about 0.5 mm.

(17) In some embodiments, the plurality of the through holes VS arranged in the through hole column C1 are also referred to as the short-circuit wall, and the distance L2 between the plurality of the through holes VS and the center of circle of the circular hollow pattern **111** is configured to adjust the impedance matching from the substrate **100** to the connector **300**. More specifically, the plurality of the through holes VS arranged in the through hole column C1 are configured to reduce the return loss and insertion loss of the radio frequency signal S transmitted from the substrate **100** to the connector **300**, whereas a lower return loss and insertion loss may be achieved when the distance L2 is approximately 0.35-fold of the wavelength of the radio frequency signal S transmitted in the substrate **100**. In this embodiment, the distance L2 is about 0.4 mm.

(18) In some embodiments, the impedance matching from the substrate **100** to the connector **300** is independent from the distance between the center of circle of the circular hollow pattern **111** and the microstrip **200**.

(19) Reference is also made to FIG. 5. FIG. 5 is a cross-sectional view of the substrate **100** in the X-Z plane obtained by a cross-sectional line passing through the center of circle of circular hollow pattern **111** and parallel to the through hole rows R1 and R2. For the ease of understanding, FIG. 5 only illustrates a portion of the structures of the substrate **100** and the microstrip **200**. The substrate **100** further includes a via VC, which penetrates the dielectric layer **130** from the conductive layer **110** to the conductive layer **120** along the Z direction. The via VC includes conductive materials and is configured to electrically couple the inner region **110a** of the conductive layer **110** to the conductive layer **120**.

(20) The connector **300** is substantially disposed above the circular hollow pattern **111** of the conductive layer **110**. The connector **300** includes an inner conductor **310**, an outer conductor **320** and an insulating layer **330**. The insulating layer **330** is configured to separate the inner conductor **310** and the outer conductor **320** from each other so that the inner conductor **310** and the outer conductor **320** are electrically insulated. The inner conductor **310** is electrically coupled to the inner region **110a** of the conductive layer **110** inside the circular hollow pattern **111**, such that the inner conductor **310** is also electrically coupled to the via VC and the conductive layer **120**. The outer conductor **320** is electrically coupled to the outer region **110b** of the conductive layer **110** outside the circular hollow pattern **111**. The connector **300** is configured to vertically extract the radio frequency signal S along the Z direction, in which the radio frequency signal is originally transmitted on the substrate **100** along the X direction.

(21) The foregoing description briefly sets forth the features of certain embodiments of the present application so that persons having ordinary skill in the art more fully understand the various aspects of the disclosure of the present application. It will be apparent to those having ordinary skill in the art that they can easily use the disclosure of the present application as a basis for designing or modifying other processes and structures to achieve the same purposes and/or benefits as the embodiments herein. It should be understood by those having ordinary skill in the art that these equivalent implementations still fall within the spirit and scope of the disclosure of the present

application and that they may be subject to various variations, substitutions, and alterations without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A signal transmitting device, configured to transmit a radio frequency signal outputted from a chip, comprising: a substrate, coupled to the chip, wherein the substrate comprises a waveguide, wherein the waveguide is configured to transmit the radio frequency signal along a first direction; and a connector, coupled to the substrate, and configured to extract the radio frequency signal from the substrate and transmit the same along a second direction, wherein the second direction is perpendicular to the substrate, wherein the substrate further comprises a plurality of through holes, wherein an area of the substrate surrounded by the plurality of through holes forms the waveguide, wherein the substrate further comprises: a first conductive layer; a second conductive layer; and a dielectric layer, wherein the first conductive layer and the second conductive layer are stacked and separated by the dielectric layer, wherein the waveguide is at least partially formed by a portion of the first conductive layer, wherein the plurality of through holes comprises a plurality of first through holes, wherein the plurality of first through holes connect the first conductive layer and the second conductive layer along the second direction, wherein the plurality of first through holes are arranged into a first through hole row and a second through hole row along the first direction, wherein the radio frequency signal is transmitted by the first conductive layer and the second conductive layer between the first through hole row and the second through hole row, wherein the portion of the first conductive layer is a portion surrounded by the first through hole row and the second through hole row.
2. The signal transmitting device of claim 1, wherein the plurality of through holes further comprises a plurality of second through holes, wherein the plurality of second through holes connect the first conductive layer and the second conductive layer along the second direction, wherein the plurality of second through holes are arranged in a first through hole column between the first through hole row and the second through hole row and along a third direction, wherein the third direction, the first direction, and the second direction are perpendicular to each other.
3. The signal transmitting device of claim 2, wherein the first conductive layer comprises a circular hollow pattern, wherein the circular hollow pattern is surrounded by the first through hole row, the second through hole row and the first through hole column, a region of the first conductive layer inside the circular hollow pattern is not coupled to a region of the first conductive layer outside the circular hollow pattern.
4. The signal transmitting device of claim 3, wherein a frequency of the radio frequency signal is about 60 GHz, and a distance between a center of circle of the circular hollow pattern and the first through hole column is about 0.35-fold to a wavelength of the radio frequency signal transmitted by the waveguide.
5. The signal transmitting device of claim 3, wherein the dielectric layer further comprises a via connecting the first conductive layer and the second conductive layer along the second direction, wherein the via is configured to electrically connect the region of the first conductive layer inside the circular hollow pattern and the second conductive layer.
6. The signal transmitting device of claim 3, wherein the connector comprises: an inner conductor, coupled to the region of the first conductive layer inside the circular hollow pattern; an insulating layer; and an outer conductor, coupled to the region of the first conductive layer outside the circular hollow pattern, wherein the insulating layer is disposed between the inner conductor and the outer conductor.
7. The signal transmitting device of claim 1, wherein the first conductive layer further comprises: a trapezoidal microstrip, coupled to the chip and the waveguide, wherein the trapezoidal microstrip has a length in the first direction, and the length is about 0.5- to one-fold of a wavelength of the

radio frequency signal transmitted by the waveguide.

8. The signal transmitting device of claim 1, wherein the substrate is configured to transmit the radio frequency signal in a transverse electric mode (TE mode).

9. A signal transmitting device, configured to transmit a radio frequency signal outputted from a chip, comprising: a microstrip, coupled to the chip and configured to receive the radio frequency signal; a substrate, coupled to the microstrip and configured to transmit the radio frequency signal along a first direction in the transverse electric mode; and a connector, configured to extract the radio frequency signal from the substrate along a second direction, wherein the second direction is perpendicular to the first direction, wherein the substrate comprises a first conductive layer coupled to the microstrip, wherein the first conductive layer and the microstrip are a monolithic conductive structure.

10. The signal transmitting device of claim 9, wherein the substrate further comprises: a second conductive layer, coupled to a ground terminal; and a dielectric layer, wherein the first conductive layer and the second conductive layer are stacked and separated by the dielectric layer, wherein the first conductive layer is coupled to the connector.

11. A signal transmitting device, configured to transmit a radio frequency signal outputted from a chip, comprising: a microstrip, coupled to the chip and configured to receive the radio frequency signal; a substrate, coupled to the microstrip and configured to transmit the radio frequency signal along a first direction in the transverse electric mode; and a connector, configured to extract the radio frequency signal from the substrate along a second direction, wherein the second direction is perpendicular to the first direction, wherein the substrate further comprises: a first conductive layer, coupled between the microstrip and the connector; a second conductive layer, coupled to a ground terminal; and a dielectric layer, wherein the first conductive layer and the second conductive layer are stacked and separated by the dielectric layer, wherein the dielectric layer has a plurality of first through holes connecting the first conductive layer and the second conductive layer along the second direction, wherein the plurality of first through holes are arranged into a first through hole row and a second through hole row along the first direction, wherein the microstrip is coupled to the first conductive layer between the first through hole row and the second through hole row.

12. The signal transmitting device of claim 11, wherein the dielectric layer further comprises a plurality of second through holes connecting the first conductive layer and the second conductive layer along the second direction, wherein the plurality of second through holes are arranged into a first through hole column between the first through hole row and the second through hole row and along a third direction, wherein the third direction, the first direction, and the second direction are perpendicular to each other.

13. The signal transmitting device of claim 12, wherein the first conductive layer comprises a circular hollow pattern, wherein the circular hollow pattern is surrounded by the first through hole row, the second through hole row and the first through hole column, a region of the first conductive layer inside the circular hollow pattern is not coupled to a region of the first conductive layer outside the circular hollow pattern.

14. The signal transmitting device of claim 13, wherein the connector comprises: an inner conductor, coupled to the region of the first conductive layer inside the circular hollow pattern; an insulating layer; and an outer conductor, coupled to the region of the first conductive layer outside the circular hollow pattern, wherein the insulating layer is disposed between the inner conductor and the outer conductor.

15. The signal transmitting device of claim 13, wherein the dielectric layer further comprises a via connecting the first conductive layer and the second conductive layer along the second direction, wherein the via is configured to electrically connect the region of the first conductive layer inside the circular hollow pattern and the second conductive layer.

16. The signal transmitting device of claim 13, wherein the substrate further comprises a waveguide, and the waveguide is at least partially formed by a portion of the first conductive layer,

wherein the portion of the first conductive layer is a region surround by the first through hole row, the second through hole row and the first through hole column.

17. The signal transmitting device of claim 13, wherein a center of circle of the circular hollow pattern and the first through hole column has a distance therebetween, and the distance is about 0.35-fold to a wavelength of the radio frequency signal transmitted by the waveguide, and a frequency of the radio frequency signal is about 60 GHz.

18. The signal transmitting device of claim 9, wherein the microstrip has a length in the first direction, and the length is about 0.5- to one-fold of a wavelength of the radio frequency signal transmitted by the waveguide.
